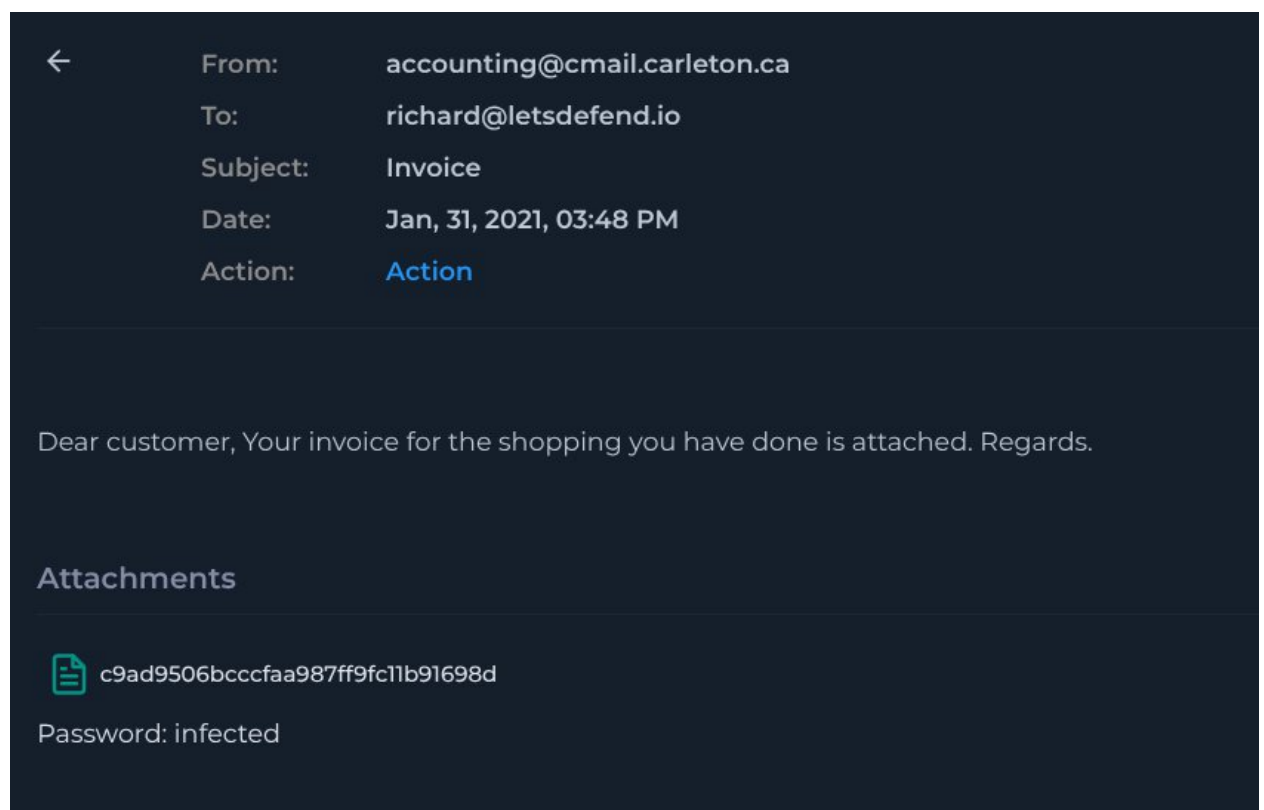


Event Information:

EventID :
45
Event Time :
Jan, 31, 2021, 03:48 PM
Rule :
SOC114 - Malicious Attachment Detected - Phishing Alert
Level :
Security Analyst
SMTP Address :
49.234.43.39
Source Address :
accounting@cmail.carleton.ca
Destination Address :
richard@letsdefend.io
E-mail Subject :
Invoice
Device Action :
Allowed

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched to find the email that triggered the alert.



Attachment name:
44e65a641fb970031c5efed324676b5018803e0a768608d3e186152102615795.xlsx

MD5hash: c9ad9506bcccf9a987ff9fc11b91698d

On VirusTotal when searching for the file hash 36/62 Vendors list the file as malicious as of 3 days ago.

36
62

Community
Score

36/62 security vendors flagged this file as malicious

44e65a641fb970031c5efed324676b5018803e0a768608d3e186152102615795

44e65a641fb970031c5efed324676b5018803e0a768608d3e186152102615795.xlsx

SHA-256 (cve-2017-11882) exploit_mechanics-dropped-file

Reanalyze

Similar

More

Size

2.12 MB

Last Analysis Date

3 days ago

PPT

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

BEHAVIOR

COMMUNITY

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Popular threat label

trojan.abphisher.adwh

Threat categories

trojan phishing downloader

Family labels

abphisher adwh cve201711882

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

AhnLab-V3	OLE/Cve-2017-11882.Gen	AICloud	Exploit.Win/CVE-2017-11882.C
ALYac	Exploit.CVE-2017-11882	Arcabit	Trojan.Phishing.AEX (many)
Avast	Other:Malware-gen [Trj]	AVG	Other:Malware-gen [Trj]
BitDefender	Trojan.Phishing.AEX	CTX	Pyl.exploit-kit.generic

Threat categories:

trojan

phishing

downloader

Family labels:

abphisher

adwh

cve201711882

However, conflictingly there are many listings for reports of the file on AnyRun and none of them list the file as malicious.

Find in Page: 698d

2 of 52

Match Case

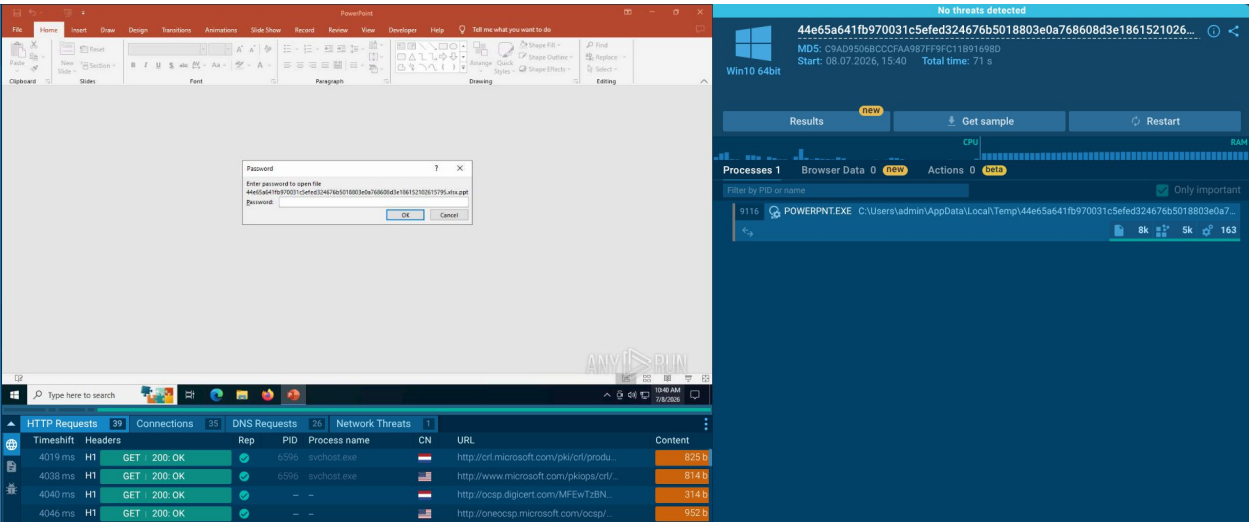
Public submissions

Q c9ad9506bccfaa987f9fc11b01598c

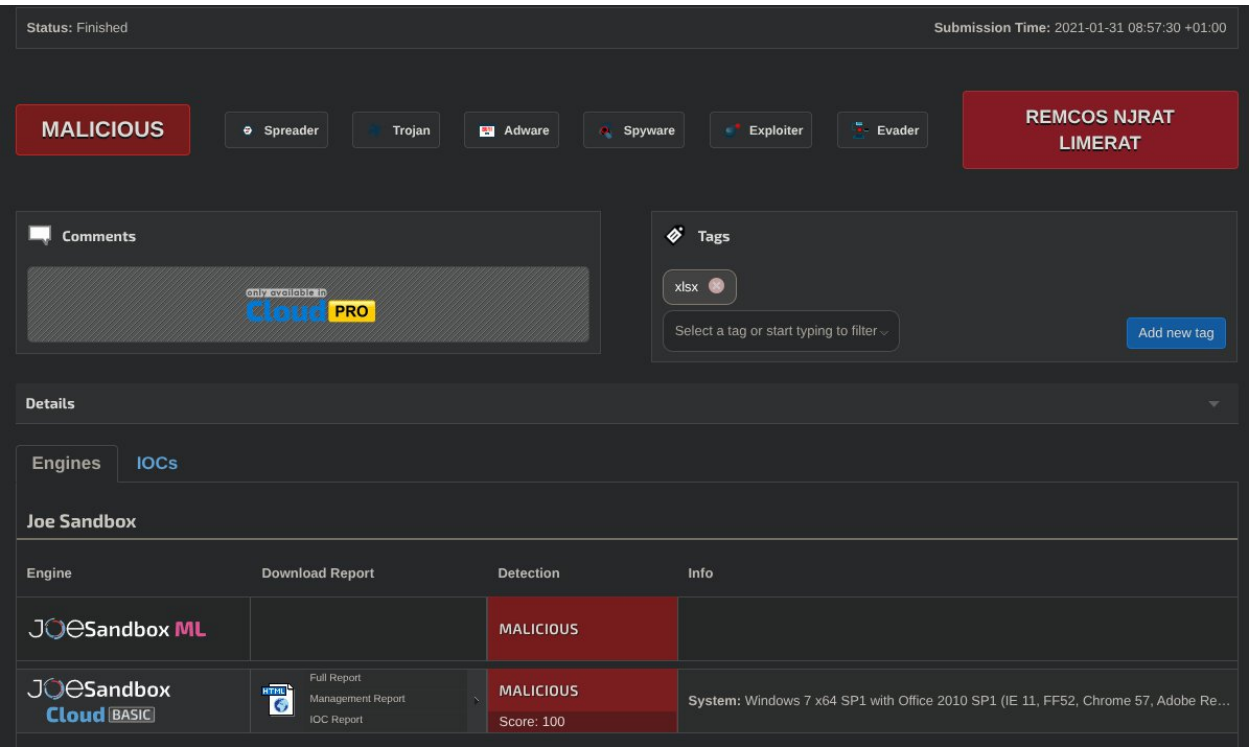
All reports

Windows 10 Professional 64 bit 30 June 2026, 00:00	✓	No threats detected	https://download.cyberlearn.academy/download/download?url=https://files-ls.s3-us-... arch-doc	SHA1: B2213859BCD686AF71C665FF56C8EB089C87754 SHA256: 30F740F6668B59AE8DC3EF5A81EAD900CTA05F17EAC95DB78023E9947989E...
Windows 10 Professional 64 bit 29 June 2026, 23:56	✓	No threats detected	https://download.cyberlearn.academy/download/download?url=https://files-ls.s3-us-... arch-doc	MD5: 2AE6106126330504764B091129452ECE SHA1: B2213859BCD686AF71C665FF56C8EB089C87754 SHA256: 30F740F6668B59AE8DC3EF5A81EAD900CTA05F17EAC95DB78023E9947989E...
Windows 7 Professional 32 bit 25 June 2026, 11:13	✓	No threats detected	44e65a641fb970031c5efed324676b5018803e0a768608d3e186152102615795.xlsx Composite Document File V2 Document, Can't read SAT	MD5: C9AD9506BCCFAA987F9FC11B01598C SHA1: E788183A2A021F74A21F609E5148B63C4EF2FE49 SHA256: 44E65A641FB970031C5EFED324676B5018803E0A768608D3E186152102615...
Windows 10 Professional 64 bit 22 June 2026, 14:41	✓	No threats detected	44e65a641fb970031c5efed324676b5018803e0a768608d3e186152102615795.xlsx Composite Document File V2 Document, Can't read SAT	MD5: C9AD9506BCCFAA987F9FC11B01598C SHA1: E788183A2A021F74A21F609E5148B63C4EF2FE49 SHA256: 44E65A641FB970031C5EFED324676B5018803E0A768608D3E186152102615...
Windows 10 Professional 64 bit 22 June 2026, 14:39	✓	No threats detected	44e65a641fb970031c5efed324676b5018803e0a768608d3e186152102615795.xlsx Composite Document File V2 Document, Can't read SAT	MD5: C9AD9506BCCFAA987F9FC11B01598C SHA1: E788183A2A021F74A21F609E5148B63C4EF2FE49 SHA256: 44E65A641FB970031C5EFED324676B5018803E0A768608D3E186152102615...
Windows 10 Professional 64 bit 09 June 2026, 17:00	✓	No threats detected	44e65a641fb970031c5efed324676b5018803e0a768608d3e186152102615795.xlsx Composite Document File V2 Document, Can't read SAT	MD5: C9AD9506BCCFAA987F9FC11B01598C SHA1: E788183A2A021F74A21F609E5148B63C4EF2FE49 SHA256: 44E65A641FB970031C5EFED324676B5018803E0A768608D3E186152102615...

It seems like these tests may have failed to progress beyond entering the required password.

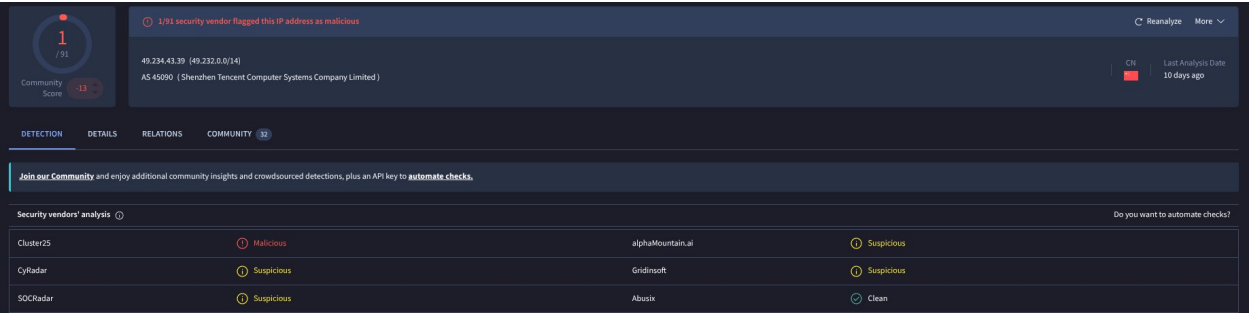


However, when checking Joe's sandbox for additional verification we can see that it is listed as malicious with a 100% certainty.

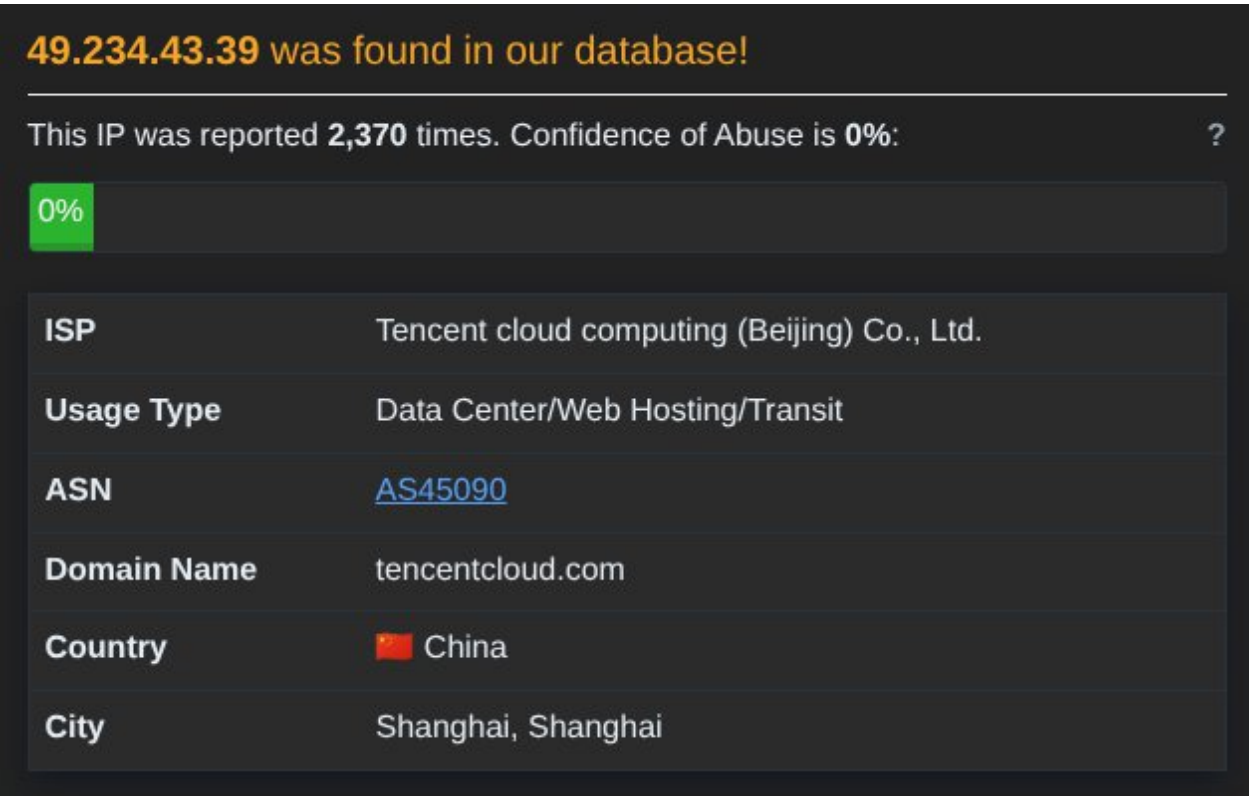


On endpoint analysis there is nothing to clearly indicate that the file was executed or any malicious infrastructure accessed during/after the incident but further analysis should be conducted to know with certainty.

The offending SMTP IP is not in our CTI database and is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a Chinese address associated with 49[.]234.43.39 AS 45090 (Shenzhen Tencent Computer Systems Company Limited). 1/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious as of 10 days ago.



On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 2,370 times with a 0% confidence of abuse.



Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a True Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a True Positive phishing alert involving a highly malicious, password-protected attachment. The threat actor delivered an encrypted Excel document disguised as an invoice, which successfully bypassed initial email gateway filters. Sandbox analysis confirms the payload contains severe Remote Access Trojans (RATs).

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC114 - Malicious Attachment Detected - Phishing Alert
- **Target Account:** richard[.]letsdefend[.]io
- **Sender Address:** accounting[.]cmail[.]carleton[.]ca
- **Sender IP:** 49[.]234.43.39
- **Email Subject:** Invoice
- **Device Action:** Allowed

Analysis and Evidence

- **Social Engineering:** The email relies on a standard financial lure, instructing the recipient that an invoice for recent shopping is attached.
- **Payload Delivery:** The email contains a password-protected attachment named 44e65a641fb970031c5efed324676b5018803e0a768608d3e186152102615795.xlsx (MD5: c9ad9506bcccf9a987ff9fc11b91698d).
- **Evasion and Execution:** While AnyRun failed to analyse the file due to the password prompt, Joe Sandbox successfully processed the file and classified it as malicious with 100% certainty.
- **Endpoint Status:** Initial endpoint analysis proved inconclusive as to whether the file was executed and so should be treated as though it has been as best practice.

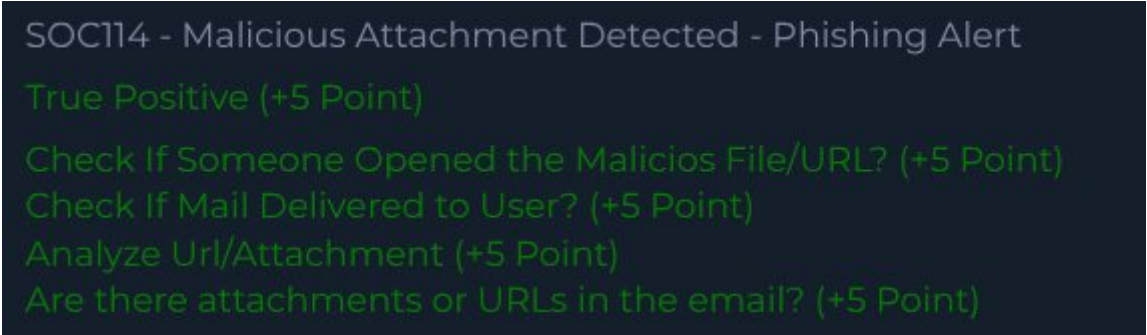
Threat Intelligence

- **File OSINT:** VirusTotal flags the file hash as malicious (36/62), specifically identifying it as an exploit for CVE-2017-11882 (a Microsoft Office Equation Editor vulnerability). Joe Sandbox identifies the payload as being associated with severe Remote Access Trojans, specifically REMCOS, NJRAT, and LIMERAT.
- **Infrastructure OSINT:** The sender IP (49[.]234.43.39) is external to the organisation and maps to Tencent Cloud in Shanghai, China. AbuseIPDB lists 2,370 user reports for this IP.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed email logs to extract the sender details, social engineering lures, and the malicious attachment.
2. Conducted OSINT and sandbox analysis, determining the encrypted .xlsx file is a weaponised CVE-2017-11882 exploit designed to drop Remote Access Trojans.
3. Verified that the device action was marked as "Allowed", meaning the payload reached the user's inbox.
4. Deleted the email from the user's inbox.
5. Isolated the device from the network.
6. Declared the alert a True Positive and escalated.

Let's Defend Result



```
SOC114 - Malicious Attachment Detected - Phishing Alert
True Positive (+5 Point)
Check If Someone Opened the Malicious File/URL? (+5 Point)
Check If Mail Delivered to User? (+5 Point)
Analyze Url/Attachment (+5 Point)
Are there attachments or URLs in the email? (+5 Point)
```